

KUSHAL SHRESTHA

SOC ANALYST | CYBERSECURITY ANALYST | SECURITY OPERATIONS

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Cybersecurity Analyst and Master of Information Technology with hands-on experience designing and operating Security Operations Centre (SOC) environments across both open-source and Microsoft security ecosystems. Skilled in SIEM monitoring, threat hunting, incident response, endpoint security, log analysis, and MITRE ATT&CK mapping. Experienced with Wazuh, Sysmon, Suricata, Snort, and currently developing expertise in Microsoft Defender XDR, Defender for Endpoint, Defender for Identity, Microsoft Sentinel, and Kusto Query Language (KQL) through hands-on SC-200 (Microsoft Security Operations Analyst) certification studies. Currently pursuing a Master of Information Technology while collaborating on industry-based cybersecurity projects focused on solving real-world security challenges. Seeking an entry-level SOC Analyst or Cybersecurity Analyst role.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- **SIEM & Detection:** Wazuh SIEM, Suricata IDS, Snort, Sysmon, Virus Total
- **Security Operations:** Defender XDR, Sentinel, Alert Triage, Log Analysis, Event Correlation, Threat Hunting, Incident Response, Vulnerability Assessment, MITRE ATT&CK Mapping
- **Network Analysis:** Wireshark, Nmap, TCP/IP, DNS, DHCP, HTTP/HTTPS, VPN, Routing & Switching
- **Endpoint & OS:** Windows 10/11, Windows Server, Kali Linux, Ubuntu Linux, Active Directory Fundamentals
- **Cloud & DevOps:** AWS Fundamentals, Docker, GitHub, Git
- **Programming & Data:** Python (Flask), HTML/CSS, Basic JavaScript, MySQL / SQL

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Cybersecurity Analyst & Researcher | Nepal Fortress Security (NFS) | Remote | March 2026 – Present

- Architected and managed a full-scale SOC home lab simulating enterprise security operations, serving as the primary environment for detection engineering and threat analysis.
- Configured Wazuh SIEM for centralized log collection from Windows and Linux endpoints, implementing custom rules to streamline real-time monitoring and reduce alert fatigue.
- Integrated Sysmon with custom configurations to capture process creation (EID 1), network connections (EID 3), and file system events for deep endpoint visibility and forensic analysis.
- Deployed Suricata IDS with signature-based detection rules to monitor network traffic, identify anomalies, and generate high-fidelity alerts on malicious payloads.
- Conducted end-to-end security investigations: triaged SIEM alerts, correlated cross-platform log sources, and escalated confirmed incidents with comprehensive investigation reports.
- Performed proactive threat hunting using network telemetry and host logs, identifying anomalous behaviours mapped directly to MITRE ATT&CK techniques (T1046 Network Service Scanning, T1110 Brute Force).
- Developed incident response playbooks, investigation reports, and security dashboards to improve analyst workflow efficiency and documentation standards.

IT Support Consultant | Global Peace Consultancy | Kathmandu, Nepal | July 2024 – 2025

- Delivered Tier 1/2 technical support for hardware, software, and network issues, maintaining high SLA resolution rates and minimizing user downtime.
- Administered Windows OS and Active Directory environments, including user account creation, permission management, and system maintenance following least-privilege principles.
- Managed data storage, backup systems, and information asset management, ensuring data integrity, confidentiality, and availability.

CYBERSECURITY PROJECTS

Microsoft Defender XDR Security Operations Lab

Tech stack: Microsoft Defender XDR • Defender for Endpoint • Defender for Identity • Microsoft Sentinel • KQL • Windows Server • Active Directory

- Built a Microsoft Defender security lab to investigate endpoint, identity, and security incidents using Microsoft security technologies.
- Practised Advanced Hunting using Kusto Query Language (KQL) to analyse security telemetry.
- Simulated credential access, persistence, command-and-control, and lateral movement techniques to validate security detections.
- Investigated alerts using Microsoft Defender portal while correlating evidence with MITRE ATT&CK tactics and techniques.
- Configured Windows Server Active Directory environment to explore Microsoft Defender for Identity deployment and identity-based attack detection.

Fortress XDR AI — AI-Powered Security Operations Platform

Tech Stack: Wazuh · Sysmon · Suricata · Docker · Python · Flask · React · MITRE ATT&CK

- Designed and built a centralized security operations platform integrating Wazuh alerts and endpoint telemetry into a unified, real-time threat monitoring dashboard.
- Implemented automated MITRE ATT&CK technique mapping to classify and prioritize incoming security events by tactic and technique ID for faster analyst evaluation.
- Developed incident management workflows featuring alert triage, investigation notes, and severity tracking to mimic enterprise ticketing systems.
- Containerized the platform using Docker to ensure environment consistency and managed continuous updates via Git/GitHub.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

- **Master of Information Technology** | Crown Institute of Higher Education (CIHE), Sydney | 2026 – Present
- **Bachelor of Information Technology** | Gateway Business College | 2022 – 2025
- **Google Cybersecurity Professional Certificate** | Google | Coursera
- **AWS Fundamentals** | Amazon Web Services | Completed
- **Microsoft Certified: Security Operations Analyst Associate (SC-200)** -In progress
- Continuous Learning: Active participant in hands-on SOC analyst pathways via TryHackMe, HackTheBox, and Blue Team Labs Online.